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JGME-D-25-01151 “Title” Original Submission

Matthew A. Porter, B.S. (Reviewer 1)

Reviewer Recommendation Term: Major Revision Overall Reviewer Manuscript Rating: 60

Custom Review Question(s): Response

Please rate the manuscript based on if the topic may be of interest to program directors or GME educators, researchers, or deans. 4=moderately agree

Please rate the manuscript based on if the conclusions are supported by data or evidence presented. 2=moderately disagree

Please rate the manuscript based on if the manuscript needs additional statistical review. 3=agree

Comments to Editor:

*Please Click on “Reviewer Instructions” at the top of this screen and read before answering the following.

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YES ___ NO *X* If yes, please contact the Editor-in-Chief.

Confidential comments to the Editor: Please make comments here to the Editor, which will not be passed on to the authors:

Confidential Comment 1 *

Comments to Author:

General Comments: This manuscript addresses an important operational challenge in graduate medical education. The authors’ decision to implement their solution using open-source optimization software (Python-based Google OR-Tools) rather than proprietary AI models or commercial platforms deserves recognition and emulation. This approach offers several advantages: zero software licensing costs, full transparency of the optimization logic, and complete reproducibility for other programs with basic programming resources. The constraint-based optimization method provides explainable, deterministic results without the privacy and cost concerns associated with conventional software and a growing number of AI “solutions”. However, the manuscript would be strengthened by explicitly acknowledging this design choice and discussing

the trade-offs between novel implementation of open-source solutions versus commercial scheduling platforms already available to residency :